The Brettonwoods Conference proposed IMF, World Bank and International Trade Organisation (ITO) in 1944. The IMF and World Bank were started in 1945. Instead of ITO, an interim arrangement was made and named GATT (General Agreement on Tariff and Trade). The GATT was transformed into WTO (World Trade Organisation) from 1995. The IMF, IBRD and WTO headquarters are presented in the table.

Institution	Headquarters	Year of Establishment
International Monetary Fund	Washington D.C	1945
World Bank	Washington D.C	1945
World Trade Organisation	Geneva	1995

8.2 International Monetary Fund

The purpose of International Monetary Fund is to secure and promote economic and financial cooperation among member countries. The IMF was established to assist the member nations to tide over the Balance of Payments disequilibrium in the short term. At present, the IMF has 189 member countries with Republic of Nauru joined in 2016.



8.2.1. Objectives Of IMF

i) To promote international monetary cooperation among the member nations.

ii) To facilitate faster and balanced growth of international trade.

iii) To ensure exchange rate stability by curbing competitive exchange depreciations.

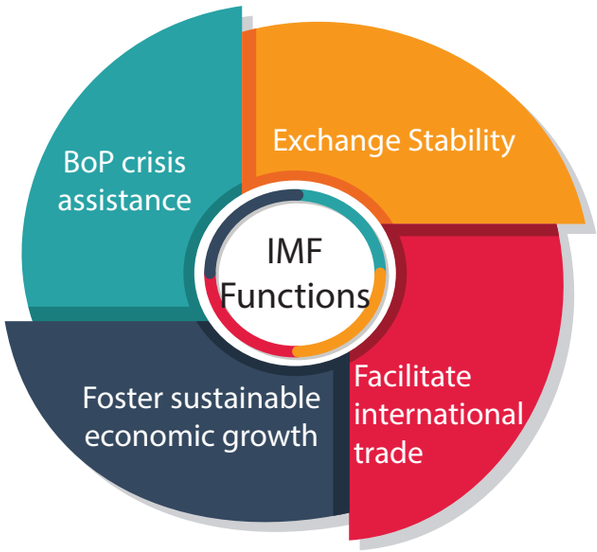
iv) To eliminate or reduce exchange controls imposed by member nations.

v) To establish multilateral trade and payment system in respect of current transactions instead of bilateral trade agreements.

vi) To promote the flow of capital from developed to developing nations.

vii) To solve the problem of international liquidity.

8.2.2 Functions Of IMF



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